



HARVESTING

Harvest pumpkins and winter squashes when they have grown to full size and their stems start to crack. It is preferable to leave them growing for as long as possible to allow their skins to harden well. Cut them from the plant with a sharp knife, with a length of stalk attached.

STORING

Pumpkins and winter squashes will store well over the winter months. Harvest them when they are fully ripe and prepare them for storage by hardening their skins for a few weeks in the sun.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Guard your crop against slugs and snails, which will target young plants. Use pellets if they attack, or deter them by setting up beer traps or laying a line of sand, grit, or copper tape around the base of plants.

Ensure that plants are well-watered and well-ventilated to discourage the spread of diseases such as powdery mildew and cucumber mosaic virus, which is especially serious, since it is incurable and will stunt and kill plants. Remove and destroy infected crops to prevent the spread of disease.